

D178

Marketing Strategy and Analytics

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

An outdoor-gear retailer with 40 stores in three states splits its customers into groups by how often they buy and whether they redeem their rewards points. The CMO joined from a beverage company last spring. Which segmentation base is the retailer using?

- A. Behavioral segmentation.
- B. Psychographic segmentation.
- C. Geographic segmentation.
- D. Demographic segmentation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A startup coffee roaster with \$2 million in seed funding decides to aim all of its marketing at one group: remote workers who brew specialty coffee at home. Its founders previously worked in retail banking. Which targeting strategy is this?

- A. Undifferentiated marketing, because the funding can support broad reach.
- B. Concentrated (niche) marketing.
- C. Micromarketing.
- D. Differentiated marketing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A furniture maker, family-owned since 1985, learns that a new tariff will raise the cost of its imported hardwood by 18% next year. Its own design team recently won an industry award. In a SWOT analysis, where does the tariff belong?

- A. Weakness.
- B. Opportunity.
- C. Threat.
- D. Strength.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a SWOT analysis, which item is a weakness?

- A.** New privacy rules will limit email marketing next year.
- B.** The company owns a patented manufacturing process.
- C.** The company's order system cannot handle more than 500 orders a day.
- D.** A major competitor is closing its local plant.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

After buying a \$1,400 laptop, a college student reads online reviews comparing it with a cheaper model and wonders whether she overspent. She had saved for the purchase over two summers of lifeguarding. Which stage of the buyer decision process is she in?

- A.** Information search.
- B.** Need recognition, shown by her two summers of saving.
- C.** Evaluation of alternatives.
- D.** Post-purchase behavior, experiencing cognitive dissonance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A snack brand that sponsors a college football bowl game decides to sell its chips through vending machines in hospitals and airports instead of only in grocery stores. Its packaging was redesigned last year. Which element of the marketing mix does this decision change?

- A.** Promotion.
- B.** Place.
- C.** Price.
- D.** Product, because packaging is part of the product.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A medical-device company launches a first-of-its-kind wearable glucose monitor protected by patents. Early buyers are clinics willing to pay a premium, and the company plans to cut the price as production scales. Its headquarters is in a new LEED-certified building. Which pricing strategy is it using?

- A. Penetration pricing, because new technology should always launch low to build share.
- B. Cost-plus pricing.
- C. Penetration pricing.
- D. Price skimming.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A new streaming service enters a crowded market and sets a low introductory price to win subscribers quickly. Which strategy is this, and what is its main risk?

- A. Penetration pricing; customers may resist later price increases and margins stay thin.
- B. Price skimming; early buyers may feel cheated when prices fall.
- C. Prestige pricing; a low price may cheapen the brand.
- D. Penetration pricing; it guarantees long-run profit once share is won.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A paid search ad for a regional credit union ran for four weeks with a budget of \$8,000. It earned 200,000 impressions and 4,000 clicks, and 120 of the people who clicked opened an account. The ad copy was tested in three versions. What is the conversion rate?

- A. 2%
- B. 3%
- C. 0.06%
- D. 33.3%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A display ad had a click-through rate of 0.5% and produced 1,500 clicks. How many impressions did it receive?

- A.** 30,000
- B.** 1,500
- C.** 7.5
- D.** 300,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A home-services company spent \$50,000 on a spring campaign run by a team of six. The campaign produced \$200,000 in incremental sales at a 40% gross margin. Last year's spring campaign won a regional marketing award. What is the return on marketing investment (ROMI)?

- A.** 62.5%
- B.** 160%
- C.** 60%
- D.** 300%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A campaign returned a ROMI of 50% on incremental gross profit of \$90,000. How much was spent on the campaign?

- A.** \$60,000
- B.** \$180,000
- C.** \$45,000
- D.** \$30,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

An outdoor-gear retailer ~~with 40 stores in three states~~ splits its customers into groups by how often they buy and whether they redeem their rewards points. ~~The CMO joined from a beverage company last spring.~~ Which segmentation base is the retailer using?

Target word: name the segmentation base **Decides:** Purchase frequency and rewards use are buying behaviors.

A	Correct	Usage rate and loyalty-program use describe how customers buy.
B	Confusion set	Psychographics are lifestyles and values, not purchase patterns.
C	Camouflage	Answers the three-state footprint, which is not how the groups are formed.
D	Adjacent category	Demographics use age, income, or family size, none of which appear in the split.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A startup coffee roaster ~~with \$2 million in seed funding~~ decides to aim all of its marketing at one group: remote workers who brew specialty coffee at home. ~~Its founders previously worked in retail banking.~~ Which targeting strategy is this?

Target word: name the targeting strategy **Decides:** One segment receives the entire marketing effort.

A	Camouflage	Answers the funding amount; the decision is to focus on one group.
B	Correct	A single, well-defined segment is the whole target.
C	Adjacent category	Micromarketing tailors to individuals or neighborhoods, narrower than a lifestyle segment.
D	Confusion set	Differentiated serves several segments with separate offers.

3. Answer C Concept 3

A furniture maker, ~~family-owned since 1985~~, learns that a new tariff will raise the cost of its imported hardwood by 18% next year. ~~Its own design team recently won an industry award.~~ In a SWOT analysis, where does the tariff belong?

Target word: SWOT quadrant for the tariff **Decides:** The tariff is an external condition that hurts the firm.

A	Adjacent category	Weaknesses are internal shortcomings; the tariff comes from outside.
B	Inverted operation	Right side (external), wrong direction: the tariff raises costs.
C	Correct	A government tariff is outside the firm's control and harms it.
D	Camouflage	Answers the design award, not the tariff.

4. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

In a SWOT analysis, which item is a weakness?

Target word: reverse: from the label to an example **Decides:** A weakness is internal and negative.

A	Adjacent category	External and negative: a threat.
B	Inverted operation	Internal but positive: a strength.
C	Correct	An internal limitation the firm controls.
D	Confusion set	External and positive: an opportunity.

5. Answer D Concept 4

After buying a \$1,400 laptop, a college student reads online reviews comparing it with a cheaper model and wonders whether she overspent. ~~She had saved for the purchase over two summers of lifeguarding.~~ Which stage of the buyer decision process is she in?

Target word: stage of the buyer decision process **Decides:** The purchase is already made; the doubt comes after.

A	Adjacent category	Search happens before the purchase decision.
B	Camouflage	The saving history is background; the stem asks where she is now.
C	Confusion set	Comparing models looks like evaluation, but she has already bought.
D	Correct	Second-guessing after buying is post-purchase dissonance.

6. Answer B Concept 5

A snack brand ~~that sponsors a college football bowl game~~ decides to sell its chips through vending machines in hospitals and airports instead of only in grocery stores. ~~Its packaging was redesigned last year.~~ Which element of the marketing mix does this decision change?

Target word: which P changes **Decides:** Adding vending channels changes how the product reaches buyers.

A	Camouflage	Answers the bowl sponsorship, which is not the decision being made.
B	Correct	Distribution channels and locations are place decisions.
C	Adjacent category	Vending prices may differ, but the decision itself is about channels.
D	Confusion set	Packaging is product, but the packaging change was last year and is not this decision.

7. Answer D Concept 6

A medical-device company launches a first-of-its-kind wearable glucose monitor protected by patents. Early buyers are clinics willing to pay a premium, and the company plans to cut the price as production scales. ~~Its headquarters is in a new LEED-certified building.~~ Which pricing strategy is it using?

Target word: name the pricing strategy **Decides:** High launch price for eager early buyers, lowered over time.

A	Absolute language	Patent protection and premium buyers are exactly when skimming works.
B	Adjacent category	Cost-plus sets price from cost, not from buyers' willingness to pay over time.
C	Inverted operation	Penetration starts low to win share; this starts high.
D	Correct	Starts high for buyers who value the innovation, then steps down.

8. Answer A Concept 6 • transfer

A new streaming service enters a crowded market and sets a low introductory price to win subscribers quickly. Which strategy is this, and what is its main risk?

Target word: reverse: from the tactic to the name and risk **Decides:** Low entry price to gain share fast.

A	Correct	Penetration trades early margin for share; raising price later is hard.
B	Inverted operation	That is the skimming risk; this price starts low.
C	Confusion set	Prestige pricing keeps prices high on purpose.
D	Absolute language	Nothing guarantees profit; share may not convert to margin.

9. Answer B Concept 7

A paid search ad for a regional credit union ran ~~for four weeks with a budget of \$8,000~~. It earned 200,000 impressions and 4,000 clicks, and 120 of the people who clicked opened an account. ~~The ad copy was tested in three versions~~. What is the conversion rate?

Target word: conversion rate **Decides:** Conversions divided by clicks.

A	Confusion set	That is the click-through rate: 4,000 / 200,000.
B	Correct	$120 / 4,000 = 0.03 = 3\%$.
C	Wrong stem number	Divides conversions by impressions instead of clicks.
D	Inverted operation	Divides clicks by conversions.

10. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

A display ad had a click-through rate of 0.5% and produced 1,500 clicks. How many impressions did it receive?

Target word: solve for impressions **Decides:** Impressions = clicks / CTR.

A	Wrong stem number	Reads 0.5% as 5% (0.05).
B	Dropped element	That is the clicks; the rate was never applied.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies clicks by the rate instead of dividing.
D	Correct	$1,500 / 0.005 = 300,000$.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A home-services company spent \$50,000 on a spring campaign ~~run by a team of six~~. The campaign produced \$200,000 in incremental sales at a 40% gross margin. ~~Last year's spring campaign won a regional marketing award~~. What is the return on marketing investment (ROMI)?

Target word: ROMI **Decides:** Incremental gross profit is $\$200,000 \times 40\% = \$80,000$.

A	Inverted operation	$\$50,000 / \$80,000$ divides spend by profit.
B	Dropped element	$\$80,000 / \$50,000$ forgets to subtract the spend.
C	Correct	$(\$80,000 - \$50,000) / \$50,000 = 0.60$.
D	Adjacent category	Uses sales instead of gross profit: $(\$200,000 - \$50,000) / \$50,000$.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

A campaign returned a ROMI of 50% on incremental gross profit of \$90,000. How much was spent on the campaign?

Target word: solve for spend **Decides:** Gross profit = spend $\times (1 + \text{ROMI})$.

A	Correct	$\$90,000 / 1.5 = \$60,000$; check: $(\$90,000 - \$60,000) / \$60,000 = 50\%$.
B	Dropped element	$\$90,000 / 0.5$ drops the 1 that returns the spend itself.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies profit by the ROMI instead of solving for spend.
D	Confusion set	That is the net return (profit minus spend), not the spend.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Segmentation bases	Demographic = who they are; geographic = where; psychographic = lifestyle and values; behavioral = how they buy and use (frequency, loyalty, benefits sought).	Calling any customer-data split demographic, or confusing lifestyle with purchase behavior.	The variable used to split: age/income, region, values, or usage/loyalty.
2	Targeting strategy	Undifferentiated = one offer for all; differentiated = separate offers for several segments; concentrated = one niche; micromarketing = individuals or localities.	Assuming a well-funded firm must go broad, or calling one-segment focus differentiated.	How many segments get their own marketing program.
3	SWOT: internal vs. external	Strengths and weaknesses are internal and controllable; opportunities and threats are external conditions in the environment.	Labeling an external negative as a weakness.	Does the fact come from inside the firm or from the market, law, or competitors?
4	Buyer decision process	Need recognition → information search → evaluation of alternatives → purchase → post-purchase behavior; doubt after buying is cognitive dissonance.	Placing post-purchase doubt in evaluation because the buyer is comparing options.	Has the purchase already happened?
5	Marketing mix (4 Ps)	Product = what is offered; price = what is charged; place = how it reaches buyers (channels); promotion = how it is communicated.	Calling a channel change promotion because it increases visibility.	The verb: design, charge, distribute, or communicate.
6	Skimming vs. penetration pricing	Skimming starts high for innovators and lowers over time; penetration starts low to win share fast in a price-sensitive market.	Assuming new technology always launches low.	Unique, protected product with eager early buyers vs. a crowded market and a race for share.
7	Funnel metrics	Click-through rate = clicks / impressions; conversion rate = conversions / clicks (or visitors).	Dividing conversions by impressions, or swapping CTR and conversion rate.	Impressions, clicks, and conversions all given in one stem.
8	Return on marketing investment	ROMI = (incremental gross profit – marketing spend) / marketing spend.	Using revenue instead of gross profit, or forgetting to subtract the spend.	Incremental sales, a margin percentage, and a campaign cost.

Course scope (public description): Marketing Strategy and Analytics is the capstone course for the marketing major. The course provides students with the opportunity to demonstrate competencies developed throughout the program by engaging in the design, implementation, and analysis of a marketing strategy. Students are given business scenarios using simulations and case studies to apply critical-thinking and decision-making skills. Students will analyze the business environment and make decisions about market segmentation, buyer behavior, and the marketing mix. Students will demonstrate the relationship between strategy and analytics by using marketing analytics to report marketing campaign results and make recommendations. This course provides students with real-world application to prepare them for the marketing industry.